

was a fiasco. According to some accounts, the conductor (the composer Alexander Glazunov) was drunk; certainly, the symphony was poorly rehearsed and performed, and the critics savaged it.



THE RUSSIAN REVOLUTION, 1917

In this painting, revolutionary soldiers are shown storming a street in Moscow during the revolution in 1917. It was in December that year that Rachmaninoff and his family fled Russia for Sweden. He never returned to his homeland.